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Windows Live**What is Windows Live?**

It's hard to define Windows Live in a couple of sentences. But according to Microsoft, "Windows Live is based on one simple idea—that your online world gets better when everything works simply and effortlessly together. So all the things you care about online—your friends, the latest information, your e-mails, searching the Net—all come together in one place." Essentially, it's a central point to access many Web-hosted services such as e-mail and IM.

When was Windows Live launched?

It went product by product. The e-mail and IM services were launched in November, and more and more services are being added.

Why Use Windows Live?

Mostly because you can access several things in one place. You have access to several services—for example, at <http://safety.live.com/site/en-US/default.htm>, you can check your computer for problems without having to download software.

How can one try out Windows Live?

Visit <http://ideas.live.com>. You'll see several sections—explore all of them! In the "Live.com beta" section, click on "Try it". You'll get to a page where you can sign up for the service, then customise "your page" by adding content to it.

Who gets to test the beta?

It's product-by-product. Microsoft sent invitations for testing Windows Live Messenger to a handful of testers, who can invite their friends later. You can visit various forums to try and get invites for beta-testing various Live components.

Where can I find more information?

Visit www.live.com to get an idea of what Windows Live offers.

a greater stake in how the Net is governed. And now, the UN has taken the first steps towards setting up a new international forum (the Internet Governance Forum, at www.intgovforum.org) to promote global interests in the governance of top-level Internet domain and country names. The Forum will not have the official decision-making function of the Internet Corporation for Assigned Names and Numbers (ICANN) in the US, it is seen as the first step in the evolution of international governance.

Greece will host the first meeting of the IGF, which is scheduled to take place by the end of June. Formally, UN secretary-general Kofi Annan has said that the role of the Forum would be to "bring all stakeholders together to share information and best practices and discuss difficult issues."

The US argues that surrendering its role in governing the Internet could hand control over to countries that do not recognise freedom of expression! Now *that's* an interesting argument!

FEARS ABOUND

Nanotech Laws Don't Protect The Public

You've probably heard of the possible dangers to the environment posed by nanotechnology—imagine what swarms of invisibly small nanoparticles, smaller than even amoebae, could do, and where they could get into! An independent report released January 11 concluded that current US laws and regulations cannot adequately protect the public against the risks of nanotechnology.

Animal studies have shown that at least some nanoparticles can cause deadly airway blockages, and can migrate from nasal passages into the brain and other organs, where they may cause metabolic problems. Other studies suggest they can trigger environmental damage that would be difficult to reverse once the minuscule particles disperse into soil and water.

Unless existing laws are modified or a new one is crafted, this latest report warns, the immense promise of nanotech, predicted to be a trillion-dollar industry by 2015 and the technology of the century, may be nipped in the bud (a poor metaphor, actually—it's hardly a bud now!) by either a disaster or an economically damaging crisis of public confidence.

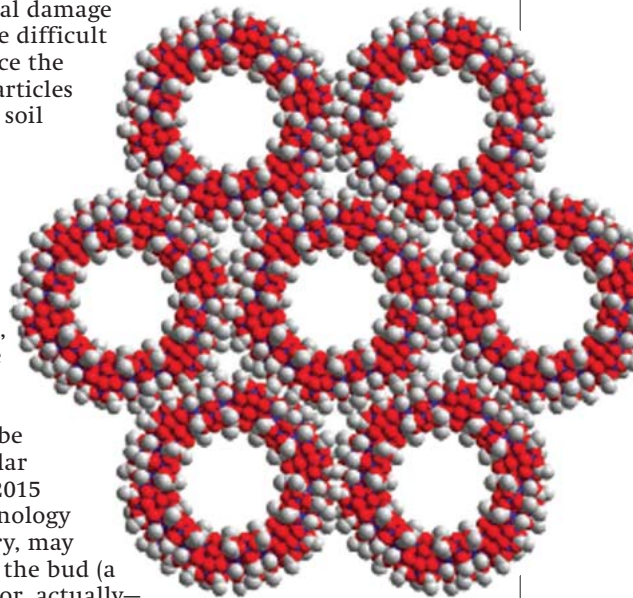
"There is a chance to still do this right and learn from previous mistakes," said J Clarence Davies, the author of the study and an environmental policy analyst who is now with Resources for the Future, a think-tank on environmental issues.

"We know from what happened with agricultural biotechnology and nuclear power that if you don't have public support, or at least public tolerance, a field's potential is not going to be realised. For nanotechnology, I don't think existing systems or laws can serve this purpose," said Davies.

Several government officials and industry representatives disputed the findings. Among them was E Clayton Teague, director of the National Nanotechnology Coordinating Office, which oversees the federal US government's \$1 billion

annual investment in nanotechnology.

"We still have so much to learn," he said. "You get one paper that says it's extremely toxic and harmful, and another that says it's not only not toxic, it's beneficial. All the



Scientists can assemble structures as complex as these from nanoparticles. This *entire* structure is 2 nanometres in diameter!

agencies we talk to have said that with the info currently available, their regulatory authorities should be adequate."

And so the debate continues—whether nanotech is safe or not, whether we know enough about it to go ahead with it or not. It has been hailed by some as a revolutionary science—and by others as a severe threat to mankind. The technology has spawned fears of unstoppable "grey goo" taking over the planet.

It's something like the cloning issue—who is to say whether human cloning is a good thing? Visit www.nanotech-now.com for lots of information on nanotechnology, what it promises, and what's being done.

So do you think nanotech is *the* technology of the 21st century, or do you think we're fools rushing in? Do write in! ☒